

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

College Name : Rajah's College Sanskrit and Tamil Studies

College Code : BDU024

Course Name : Streamlining IT Procurement

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Problem Statement:

The existing IT procurement workflow suffers from a lack of automation, causing delays and unnecessary manual effort — especially when it comes to processing standard laptop requests. Configuration of these laptops is a step that's frequently missed or delayed, which leads to user dissatisfaction and poor utilisation of IT resources.

User Story:

As part of the IT procurement team, I want an automated system for handling standard laptop requests so that configuration tasks are created and routed to the hardware team without manual effort. This ensures laptops are configured as soon as they arrive, cutting down wait times for users and reducing manual work.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

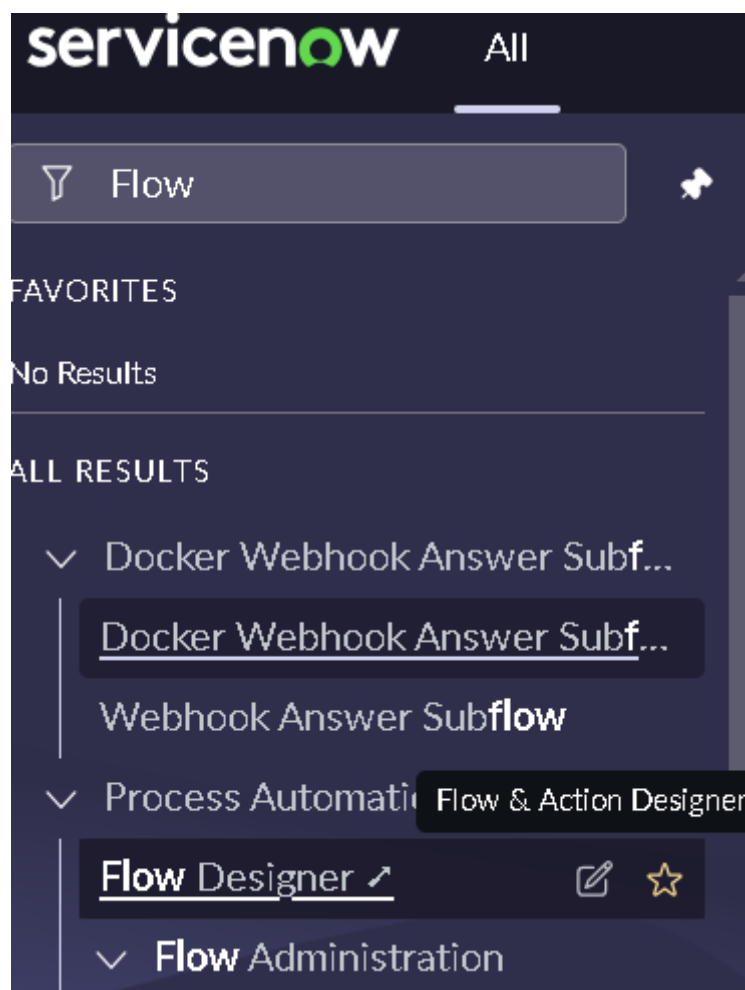
- 1 Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
- 2 Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
- 3 Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
- 4 Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

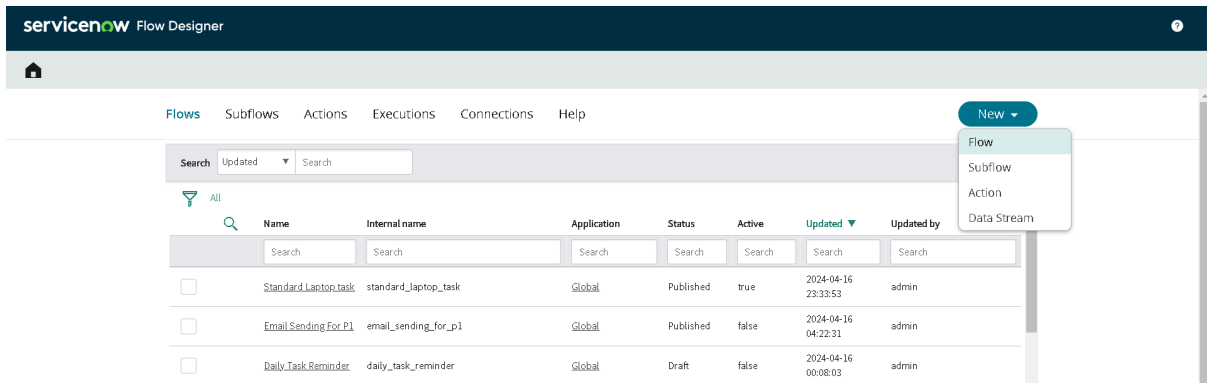
TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.





Flow properties

* Flow name: Standard Laptop task

Description: Describe your flow

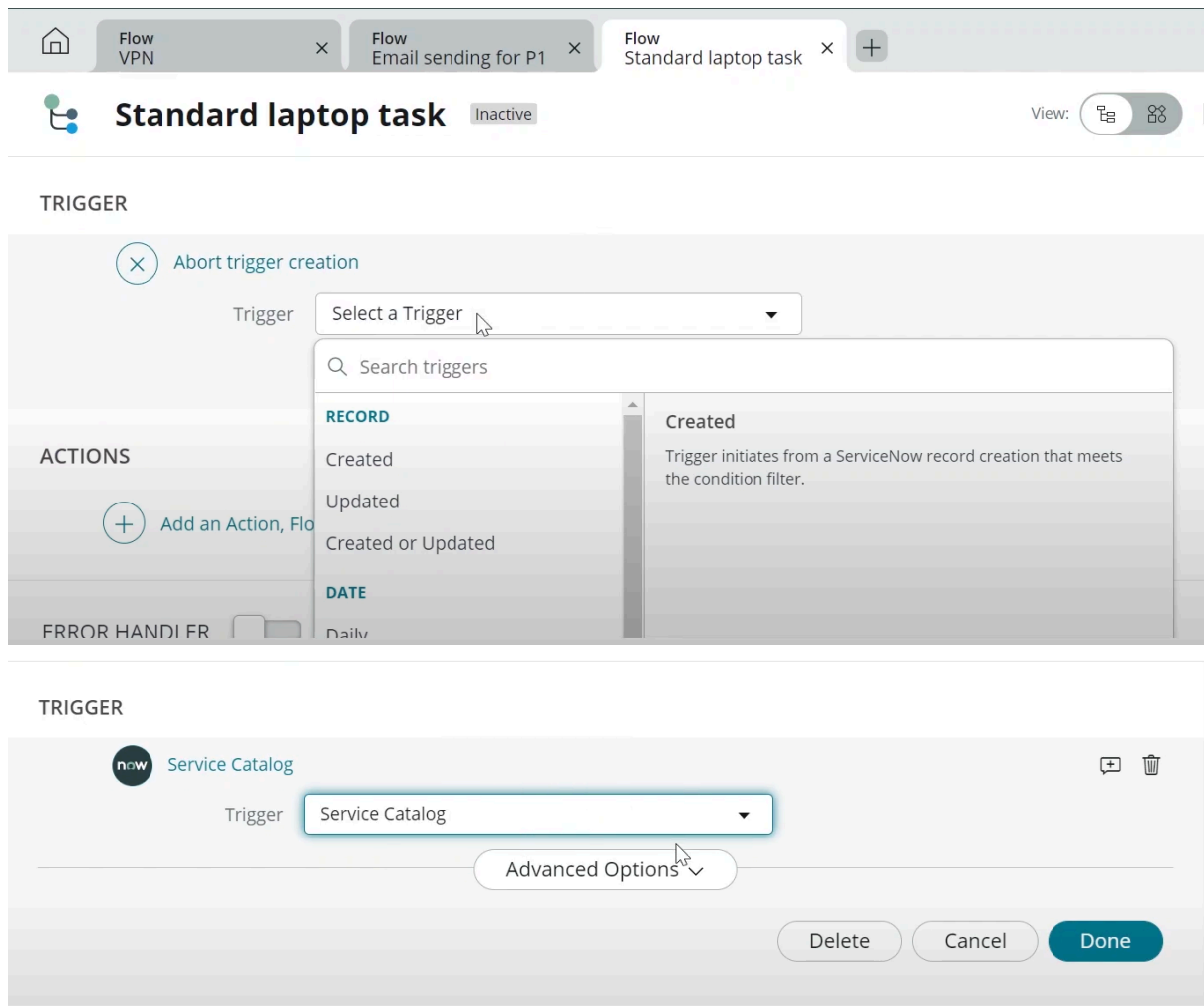
Application: Global

Protection: -- None --

Run As: System User

Cancel Submit

9. Click on Add a trigger
10. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.
11. After that click on Done.



12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



Standard Laptop task

Active



Action

Flow Logic

Subflow

Search Actions

Create Catalog Task



Most Recent



Popular

INSTALLED SPOKES



ServiceNow Core



Connect



AES Portal UI Template



Deployment Pipeline



Virtual Agent



Password Reset



AES Flow Templates



Global

Create Catalog Task

ServiceNow Core

Look Up Record

ServiceNow Core

Wait For Condition

ServiceNow Core

Create Record

ServiceNow Core

SLA Percentage Timer

ServiceNow Core

Send Email

ServiceNow Core

Update Record

ServiceNow Core

Create Templated ACL



Standard Laptop task

Active

View:



Test

De

1



Create Catalog Task

Action

Create Catalog Task

Table Name

Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]

Trigger - ... Requested Item ...

Short Description

Laptop needs to Configured

Fields

Description



Laptop needs to Configured



Assignment group



Hardware



Approval



Approved



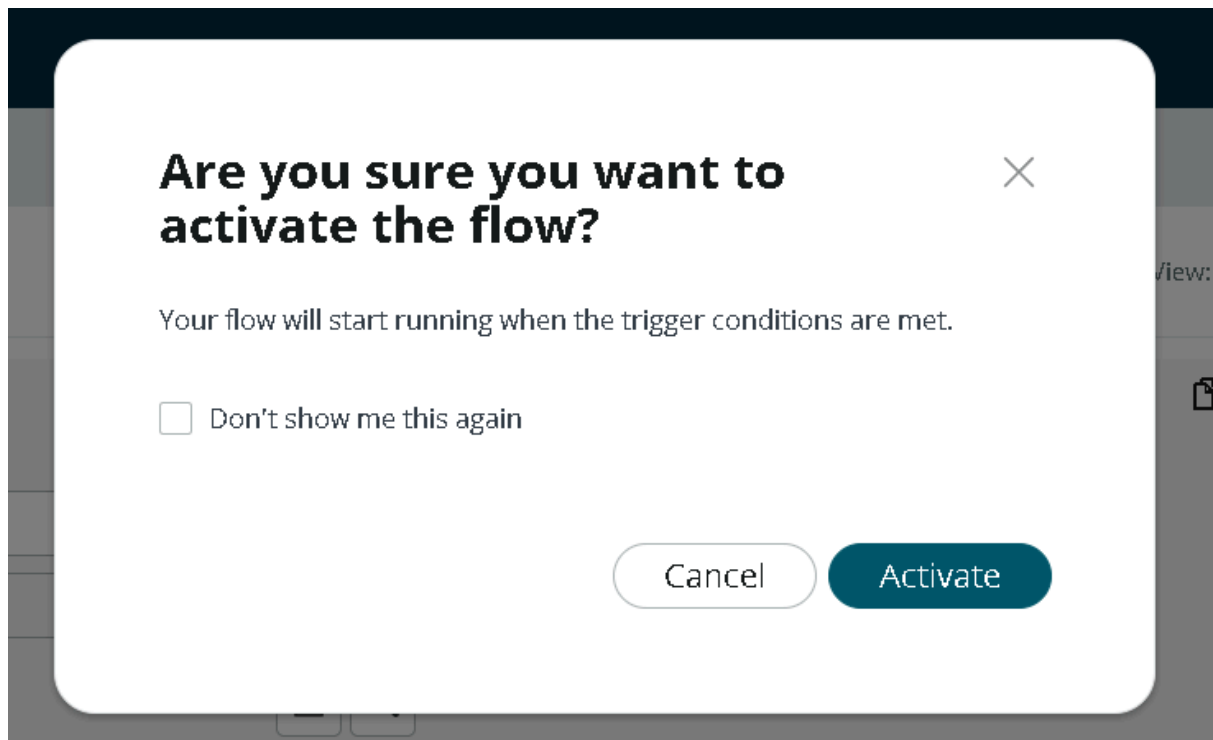
+ Add field value

Wait



Template Catalog

Select Template Catalog Item



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbon x1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27\" Monitor	Size - 27\", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22\" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24\" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

Catalog Item: Standard Laptop

Name: Standard Laptop Application: Global

Catalogs: Service Catalog Active: ☒

Category: Hardware Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

State: -- None --

Checked out: -- None --

Owner:

Process Engine

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow: Standard Laptop task

Workflow:

Execution Plan:

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.

[Favorites](#)
[History](#)
[Workspaces](#)
[Admin](#)

Standard Laptop ☆

[Service Catalog](#) > [Hardware](#) > Standard Laptop

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☐ Adobe Acrobat
☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Quantity

Subtotal ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Delivery t **Order Now** 0 Days

Order Now

[Add to Cart](#)

Shopping Cart

Empty

- Now we will see the Order status
- In that click on the Request Number

Order Status

[Back to Catalog](#)
[Continue Shopping](#)
[Home](#)

Thank you, your request has been submitted
 ×

Order Placed: 2024-04-17 04:07:11

Request Number: [REQ0010001](#) ☆

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2024-04-17

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2024-04-17	▶	₹91,931.2306 +₹8,357.3846 Annually	1	₹91,931.2306 +₹8,357.3846 Annually
				Total	₹91,931.2306 +₹8,357.3846 Annually

[Back to Catalog](#)
[Continue Shopping](#)

[Home](#)

- It will open the Requested number record.
- Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

Favorites

History

Workspaces

Admin

Request - REQ0010001

Search

Request REQ0010001

Discuss

Follow

Update

Add New Item

Cancel Request

Copy

Delete

Short description

Special instructions

Update

Add New Item

Cancel Request

Copy

Delete

Related Links

[Show Workflow](#)

[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1)

Approvers (1)

Recurring Prices (1)

State

Search

Approval for = REQ0010001

State

Approver

Comments

Created

Requested

Eric Schroeder

2024-04-17 04:07:12

1

to 1 of 1

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Update

Add New Item

Cancel Request

Copy

Delete

Related Links

[Show Workflow](#)

[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1)

Prices (1)

State

Search

Approval for = REQ0010001

State

Approver

Comments

Created

Requested

Eric Schroeder

2024-04-17 04:07:12

1

to 1 of 1

Show Matching

Filter Out

Copy URL to Clipboard

Copy sys_id

Assign Tag

Approve

Reject

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Favorites

History

Workspaces

Admin

Requested Item - RITM0010001

Search

Requested Item RITM0010001

Discuss

Follow

Update

Delete

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Impact 3 - Low

Opened by System Administrator

Priority 4 - Low

State Open

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

Update

Delete

Related Links

[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1)

Approvers

Group approvals

Number

Search

Request item = RITM0010001

Number

Assignment group

Assigned to

Short description

Actual start

Actual end

Order

SCTASK0010001

Hardware

(empty)

Laptop needs to Configured

2024-04-17 04:11:40

(empty)

1

to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the “Catalog tasks ” Section
13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

The screenshot displays a ServiceNow Catalog Task record for SCTASK0010001. The interface includes a top navigation bar with buttons for Discuss, Follow, Update, Close Task, and Delete. The record details are organized into two columns. The left column contains fields for Number (SCTASK0010001), Assigned to (with a search icon), Configuration item (with a search icon), Active (checked), Short description (Laptop needs to Configured), Description (Laptop needs to Configured), and Worknotes (Worknotes). The right column contains fields for Approval (Approved), Priority (4 - Low), State (Open), Request item (RITM0010001), and Requested for (System Administrator). A Post button is located at the bottom right of the Worknotes field. The bottom of the screen shows a partial view of the 'Activations' section.

Number	SCTASK0010001	Approval	Approved
Assigned to		Priority	4 - Low
Configuration item		State	Open
Active	☒	Request item	RITM0010001
Short description	Laptop needs to Configured	Requested for	System Administrator
Description	Laptop needs to Configured		
Worknotes	Worknotes		

Conclusion:

This project automates the standard laptop procurement workflow using ServiceNow's Flow Designer, successfully removing the inefficiencies and manual overhead that previously existed in the process. The new workflow guarantees laptops are configured without delay, cuts down on user waiting time, and boosts overall efficiency in the IT department. Beyond saving resources, this automation also delivers a smoother, more reliable experience for anyone requesting a laptop.